



PS Vita joins the club

Sony set to release PlayStation Plus for the PS Plus members this November with features like Instant Game Collection



Assassin's Creed III

Get ready for the new episode of Connor with added realistic elements to the game along with high end graphics

Don't get lost with Apple Maps, turn to these free alternatives

In a very short time after its release on iOS 6.0, Apple Maps has been the object of ridicule and frustration. We recommend these free alternatives

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If you are among those who have been very disappointed with the new maps on iOS 6, you are in very good company. Fortunately, there are a number of free apps out on the iTunes App Store that will let you find your way around town, without paying anything more than data charges. They might not be as good as Google Maps, but while we wait for a Google Maps app (will one ever come?).

Navfree GPS Live India

Perhaps the best free navigation app for those in India, Navfree claims to operate on what it says is "map data created by a community of thousands of users around the world." Yes, we know that may not sound too reassuring to some people, but the app does work rather well for well-known areas. It gets data from OpenStreetMap and also has the massive benefit of working offline (it is a 157 MB one time download). It comes with features like navigating to an address, points of interest, the option to send location to your social networks also to tweak to night mode, if need be.

Global Navigator Free

Its interface might not set the world on fire, but there is no doubting the utility of this



Global Navigator Free finds your way

handy app. Actually, the app lets you choose from a variety of maps - including Google Maps, Yahoo! Maps, Bing Maps, and Google Earth - as you make your way around town. You can save routes and do local and global searches, but do so online if you have unlimited data connection, because this app heads to the Web to pull apps. You will need to upgrade to the Pro version if you want offline browsing. Still, if it is just a quick navigation fix you are looking for with lots of maps to choose from, then this is not a bad option at all.

PD Maps Worldwide Edition

Another app that works by letting users access a number of mapping services through its

interface, PD Maps can summon up maps from OpenStreet, Yahoo!, Google, Bing, Panoramio and a few others, and in a rather innovative twist, lets you choose not just the mapping but also the routing service. So one could actually choose to see a map in Bing and opt for Google's routing service, which is neat but not recommended, as it does take forever to load even on a 3G connection. Which incidentally is something we need to warn you about - there is no offline navigation here (unless you are willing to pay for it), so be ready to dole out data charges every time you go navigating.

Waze

It is called the social GPS app by many people and remains one of our firm favourites among free navigation options. Although it first made waves because it allowed users to share traffic data with each other, alerting people to jams on the way, and also to swap messages in the process, Waze is also a very nifty navigator in its own right and works very briskly too. It comes with social media connectivity as well as the ability to join or create driving groups to find out what's happening on routes you frequently use.

The spellings of some Indian locations can be a bit weird but we love the speed with which the app works and its social angle. And it is totally free - no hidden print - with maps that get updated fairly regularly.

Glympse

We can hear the howls of protest from those who have used this nifty little app in the past. Yes, Glympse is not classically a navigation app - it is designed for the user to be able to share their location and travel route with a select group of people. But it DOES have a navigation aspect. If you are sent a person's location, you can use the app to get directions to either that location or their destination, using Google Maps online. No, not classical navigation as we know it, but very very handy for those occasions when you have to see a person rather than visit a place and do not know where they are. Just make sure both of you have Glympse installed on your devices.

Google Maps

If you are really yearning for the Google Maps experience, well, it is just a URL away. Point your browser to <http://maps.google.com> and you will be able to see Google Maps in all its glory and get navigation options that include walking, driving and public transport. No, it won't work as smoothly as it did through the native app but it's still handy 📱